overseas colonies. One-fifth of the globe was now made up of European Colonies including the territories of Africa.

Europe's plans for the African region provoked considerable political and diplomatic responses from African leaders, who eventually resorted to military resistance. This resistance had two primary forms: guerrilla warfare often used by small-scale, decentralized societies and direct military engagement that was most commonly used by centralized state systems.

European powers sent agents to sign treaties of protection with the leaders of African nations, kingdoms and societies. These agreements often had clauses that the African leaders did not agree to, which resulted in military resistance. The Europeans thought that the Africans had signed their sovereignty away, but the Africans thought the treaties were only diplomatic and commercial deals. After discovering the truth, African leaders felt betrayed by the European powers who had been trying to impose political and economic authority on their territories.

The European powers were made up of Britain, Portugal and France, which claimed for themselves regions in both Africa and Asia. Similarly, emerging powers like Germany and Italy did the same but on a smaller scale. At the time, European states felt the need to grow politically and economically. Possessing vast chunks of territory seemed to be extremely necessary in lieu of what they had planned for their nations. European powers were driven by lust for both economic and political growth, which resulted in a competition and constant struggle between the colonies and even the powers themselves.

The colonizing nations used strategic government policies. The French, Portuguese, Germans and the Belgians exercised a centralized government known as "direct rule." For example, France ruled its African colonies from France. They appointed chiefs individually considering their loyalty to the nation only. They had established large colonies in Africa: French West Africa and French Equatorial Africa. Therefore, France assigned officials, passed laws and approved any type of measurement before it could be passed by colonial assemblies.